



Green Dog Attendance Policy

At Green Dog we view **reliability** as an absolute, not a scale. Regular and timely attendance is an essential function of every team member's job; think of it as the first thing on every job description's daily task list. Your team counts on your attendance. That being said, life happens, and you will never be judged for being ill or suffering unexpected delays. However, the frequency of and how you handle yourself in these instances will be evaluated.

So You're Not Feeling Well or You're Running Late? How Do You Let Us Know?

- Angela Lina Perez (Angie) is the point person for **ALL** call-outs and tardies.

IN-HOUSE STAFF

- **TARDIES:**

- o If you are going to be tardy, please Slack Angie with your estimated time of arrival as soon as possible. She will notify your team through the "callouts-tardies" Slack channel.
- o You are officially considered tardy if you are at least 15 minutes late for your shift.
- o Your tardy will be excused if (1) you provide a doctor's note/documentation as reason for your tardiness, (2) your tardiness is due to an unforeseen emergency/illness and you give as much notice and proof as possible (for example, you got a flat tire and you provide a time stamped photo of the tire and let the team know the situation as soon as possible), (3) your tardiness is due to an unexpected family emergency.
- o Your tardy will also be excused if you Slack Angie at least 12 hours before your shift (for sickness or emergency, not for a scheduled appointment that you already knew of).

- **CALL-OUTS/ABSENCES:**

- o If you cannot make it to your scheduled shift, be sure to **CALL** Angie as soon as you know you are not going to make it into work. She will notify your team through the "callouts-tardies" Slack channel.
- o If your schedule has already been released and you need the day off, it's your responsibility to find coverage for that shift and inform Angie and Bianca.
- o Your absence will be excused if (1) you provide a doctor's note/documentation as reason for your absence, (2) your absence is due to an unforeseen emergency/illness and you give as much notice and proof as possible (for example, you got a flat tire and you provide a time stamped photo of the tire and let the team know the situation as soon as possible), (3) your absence is due to an unexpected family emergency.
- o Your absence will also be excused if you **CALL** Angie at least 12 hours before your shift (for sickness or emergency, not for a scheduled appointment that you already knew of) **AND** you find coverage for your shift with someone who has an equivalent skill set.

- o If you cannot reach Angie via phone call, then please leave a voicemail stating the reason for your call-out.

- **PLEASE NOTE:**

- o Texting/messaging via SLACK are **NOT** accepted forms of communication in regards to call-outs/absences.
- o Any appointments, including doctor's appointments, are unexcused unless requested ahead of time via When I Work.
- o We understand that the unexpected happens, however excessive habitual and/or last-minute absences and tardies cannot be tolerated. This places a burden on the rest of our team and directly affects our clients and patient care.

REMOTE STAFF

- **TARDIES:**

- o If you are going to be tardy, please Slack Angie, Tiffany Tesoro, Ashley Paredes, and Bianca together with your estimated time of arrival as soon as possible.
- o You are officially considered tardy if you are at least 15 minutes late for your shift.
- o Your tardy will be excused if (1) you provide a doctor's note/documentation as reason for your tardiness, (2) your tardiness is due to an unforeseen emergency/illness and you give as much notice and proof as possible (for example, you got a flat tire and you provide a time stamped photo of the tire and let the team know the situation as soon as possible), (3) your tardiness is due to an unexpected family emergency.
- o Your tardy will also be excused if you Slack Angie, Tiffany Tesoro, and Bianca at least 12 hours before your shift (for sickness or emergency, not for a scheduled appointment that you already knew of).

- **CALL-OUTS:**

- o If you cannot make it to your scheduled shift, be sure to **CALL** Angie as soon as you know you are not going to make it into work.
- o If your schedule has already been released and you need the day off, it's your responsibility to find coverage for that shift and inform Angie, Tiffany Tesoro, Ashley Paredes, and Bianca.
- o Your absence will be excused if (1) you provide a doctor's note/documentation as reason for your absence, (2) your absence is due to an unforeseen emergency/illness and you give as much notice and proof as possible (for example, you got a flat tire and you provide a time stamped photo of the tire and let the team know the situation as soon as possible), (3) your absence is due to an unexpected family emergency.
- o Your absence will also be excused if you **CALL** Angie at least 12 hours before your shift (for sickness or emergency, not for a scheduled appointment that you already knew of) **AND** you find coverage for your shift with someone who has an equivalent skill set.

- **LOSS OF POWER/ INTERNET:**

- o As a remote employee, part of your daily responsibility is to make sure you have reliable working power and internet. If you lose power or internet, you are still responsible for getting your work done on your scheduled shift. Thus, relocating to a location with working internet and power is expected within one hour of loss of power/internet.
- o In the event you lose power or internet, you must send proof from your power or internet provider of said outage otherwise it will count against your attendance.

- **PLEASE NOTE:**

- Texting/messaging via SLACK are **NOT** accepted forms of communication in regards to call-outs/absences.
- Any appointments, including doctor's appointments, are unexcused unless requested ahead of time via When I Work.
- We understand that the unexpected happens, however excessive habitual and/or last-minute absences and tardies cannot be tolerated. This places a burden on the rest of our team and directly affects our clients and patient care.

So you need to work OVERTIME? How do you let us know?

- If you are going to need to work overtime, you must seek approval from your immediate manager/supervisor.
- Please Slack Angie, Ana, Gladys, Cynthia, Bianca, and Deija together in a group chat the DAY OF YOUR OVERTIME to let management know that you worked overtime that day. Please include the name of the manager who approved your overtime in your message. For example, "I had to stay later today because we were shortstaffed. Bianca approved my overtime."
- **For remote staff**, please also include Tiffany Tesoro and Ashley Paredes to the group chat for the overtime notification.

So you need to LEAVE EARLY? How do you let us know?

- If you are going to need to leave work early for any reason, you must notify your immediate manager/supervisor.
- Please Slack Angie, Ana, Gladys, Cynthia, Bianca, and Deija together in a group chat the DAY YOU NEED TO LEAVE EARLY to let management know that you left early that day. Please include the name of the manager who you notified in your message. For example, "I had to leave early today because I wasn't feeling well. I notified Bianca before I left."
- **For remote staff**, please also include Tiffany Tesoro and Ashley Paredes to the group chat for the ending shifts early notification.

GRACE POINT SYSTEM

Effective: August 1, 2024

UPDATED January 1, 2026

Green Dog Veterinary Center will be implementing the Grace Point system to monitor attendance for all staff.

- Each employee will start each calendar year with 0 points.
- For each attendance infraction 1 - 4 points will be added.
- You will be updated with how many standing points you currently have if any point(s) is/are added. This communication will be via Slack. You can always reach out directly to the HR team (Angie, Ana, Cynthia, and Gladys) to inquire about how many points you currently have.
 - **1 TARDY is an addition of 1/2 point**
 - **1 ABSENCE is an addition of 4 points**

- Any team member who reaches **12 points** due to unexcused absences or excessive tardiness will be contacted by HR with a written warning via docusign.
- Any team member who reaches **18 points** due to unexcused absences or excessive tardiness will receive a formal written warning via docusign and will be required to attend a meeting with the HR department and the management team. Accumulating **18 points** in a calendar year can lead to disciplinary action **including probation, suspension, and/or termination of position.**
- Please see the below examples for the Grace Point system:
 - o *Example: If an employee has **0 Grace Points** and they call out the morning of their shift, without an approved emergency exception, they will **gain 4 Grace Points**.*
 - o *Example: If an employee has **8 Grace Points** and they call out the morning of their shift, without an approved emergency exception, they will **gain 4 Grace Points** and will have reached a total of **12 points** for the year. Subsequently, the employee will be contacted by HR with a written warning.*
 - o *Example: If an employee has **14 Grace Points** and they call out the morning of their shift, without an approved emergency exception, they will **gain 4 Grace Points** and will have reached a total of **18 points** for the year. This employee will receive a formal write up, will be required to attend a meeting with the HR department and the management team, and may face disciplinary action up to and including termination.*

SUSPENSIONS/PROBATION

Effective: February 1, 2025

UPDATED January 1, 2026

Disciplinary suspensions and/or probation will now be implemented as a disciplinary action according to California state law guidelines.

- Each employee is at risk of being put on a 2 month probation **OR** receiving a suspension after surpassing 18 attendance points due to unexcused absences and tardies for the year.
- An employee will have a meeting with management and receive at least one written warning via Docusign to give them a chance to remedy their behavior before disciplinary suspensions are implemented.
- An employee cannot use PTO if they are suspended—this is a disciplinary action, not a voluntary vacation.

Green Dog Veterinary Center will be implementing suspensions as a disciplinary action according to Cal. Code Regs. Tit. 15, § 3392.5 - Employee Disciplinary Matrix, attached below. Please disregard the salary reductions; Green Dog will only be implementing the suspension days.

The suspensions will also be implemented in order. Therefore, the first suspension that an employee would receive would be a “suspension without pay for 1-2 qualifying work days.” If an employee’s

attendance does not improve, then they should expect to receive a “suspension without pay for 3-12 qualifying work days.”

This being said, suspensions are Green Dog Veterinary Center’s last resort; management still has the right to terminate an employee without implementing suspensions as a disciplinary action.

(a) Employee Disciplinary Matrix Penalty Levels:

1. Letter of Reprimand	4. Salary Reduction 10% for 7-12 Qualifying Pay Periods; or	7. Salary Reduction 10% for 31-45 Qualifying Pay Periods; or
	Suspension Without Pay for 14-24 Qualifying Work Days.	Suspension Without Pay for 62-90 Qualifying Work Days.
2. Salary Reduction 5% for 1-2 Qualifying Pay Periods; or	5. Salary Reduction 5% for 25-36 Qualifying Pay Periods; or	8. Temporary Demotion to a lower class for 12-24 Qualifying Pay Periods; or
Suspension Without Pay for 1-2 Qualifying Work Days.	Suspension Without Pay for 25-36 Qualifying Work Days.	Permanent Demotion.
3. Salary Reduction 5% for 3-12 Qualifying Pay Periods; or	6. Salary Reduction 10% for 19-30 Qualifying Pay Periods; or	9. Dismissal.
Suspension Without Pay for 3-12 Qualifying Work Days.	Suspension Without Pay for 38-60 Qualifying Work Days.	

It is Important to Remember...

- We want you to take good care of yourself and we appreciate you limiting your exposure to others when you are ill.
- You are still able to use PTO for any absences if you choose to do so, provided you have PTO available for use. This must be requested at the end of the pay period via the Payroll Questionnaire.
- Available PTO will not be applied unless the employee requests it and it is approved.
- Full-time employees are provided with PTO/sick hours after their introductory period.
- Absences due to illness totaling more than **3 consecutive shifts** may result in the employee being placed on a leave of absence, which will require medical certification and a release from a healthcare provider, before the employee is able to return to work.
- If you are absent for more than **3 consecutive days** and we cannot get a hold of you/you do not contact management, we will consider this job abandonment and you may be terminated from your position.
- In some cases, a doctor's note may be required to return to work.

Meal Periods and Rest Breaks

- Non-exempt employees working more than five hours per day are entitled to one unpaid meal period of at least 30 minutes. We expect all lunches to be started prior to the start of the 5th hour. The meal period may be waived by mutual consent of a supervisor and employee, but only if the employee works fewer than six hours during the workday.

Other Meal Periods and Rest Breaks That May Apply on Occasion

- Non-exempt employees working more than ten hours per day are entitled to two unpaid meal periods of at least 30 minutes each. However, they may waive the second meal period by mutual consent of a supervisor and employee, but only if working fewer than twelve hours in one workday and the first meal period was not waived.
- Non-exempt employees working between three-and-a-half and six hours per day will receive one ten-minute paid rest break, occurring as near as possible to the middle of the work period.
- Non-exempt employees working between six and ten hours per day will receive two ten-minute paid rest breaks, occurring toward the middle of each four hour work period, or major fraction thereof.
- Non-exempt employees working between ten and fourteen hours per day will receive three ten-minute paid rest breaks, occurring toward the middle of each four hour work period, or major fraction thereof.
- Non-exempt employees working less than three-and-a-half hours per day are not entitled to rest breaks.
- Rest breaks are expected to be taken away from the work environment to allow employees on break to be uninterrupted, and to avoid distracting those who are working.
- Adding together breaks and meal periods into a single block of time is not permitted.